The Resume Template Pack

10 ATS-Optimized Templates for Every Career Situation

Empire Rewards — Free Edition

INTRODUCTION

You have 10 resume templates in this pack. This guide tells you which one to use, how to customize it, and how to make sure it passes the applicant tracking systems that reject 75% of resumes before a human ever reads them.

Every template in this pack was built with the same core principles:

- **Single-column layouts** that parse cleanly across every major ATS
- **Standard section headings** (Work Experience, Education, Skills)
- **Standard fonts** (Arial, Calibri, Helvetica, Georgia, Times New Roman)
- **No tables, text boxes, images, or graphics**
- **Clean formatting** that looks professional to human reviewers

You get a .docx file (fully editable) and a PDF version (ready to send) for each template.

Let's begin.

PART 1: WHICH TEMPLATE SHOULD YOU USE?

Each of the 10 templates is designed for a specific situation. Find yours below.

Template 1: Clean Minimalist — Classic

Best for: Corporate, finance, law, accounting, government, and any traditional industry.
Why: Conservative formatting signals you understand professional norms. Zero design elements, just clean typography.

Template 2: Clean Minimalist — Modern

Best for: Any industry when you're not sure what else to use.
Why: Same minimalist structure as Template 1, with subtle typographic refinements. Universally safe.

Template 3: Modern Professional — A

Best for: Tech, marketing, product, and startup roles.
Why: Contemporary design with subtle color accents. Includes a skills sidebar that stays single-column to keep ATS parsing intact.

Template 4: Modern Professional — B

Best for: Product, UX, design-adjacent roles, and creative-adjacent professionals.
Why: Refined typography with stronger visual hierarchy. Still clean and single-column.

Template 5: Modern Professional — C

Best for: Sales, business development, and any quota-driven role.
Why: Emphasizes metrics and results with a "Key Achievements" section at the top of the page.

Template 6: Creative — Bold

Best for: Graphic design, advertising, branding, and visual roles.
Why: Standout typography and spacing. Still ATS-safe — no columns, no graphics, no tables.

Template 7: Creative — Refined

Best for: Media, fashion, entertainment, and editorial roles.
Why: Elegant design with generous white space. Includes space for portfolio links.

Template 8: Executive

Best for: Directors, VPs, C-suite candidates.
Why: Sophisticated, authoritative design. Emphasizes leadership achievements, strategic impact, and board-level experience.

Template 9: Entry-Level

Best for: Recent graduates and candidates without much work history.
Why: Prioritizes education, skills, and projects. Includes a "Relevant Coursework" section.

Template 10: Career Change

Best for: Professionals switching industries.
Why: Functional format that groups experience by skill rather than chronology. Perfect for highlighting transferable skills.

The Decision Tree

Still not sure? Work through these questions:

Are you in a traditional industry (finance, law, government, accounting)?
→ Template 1 (Clean Minimalist — Classic)

Are you in tech, marketing, or a startup?
→ Template 3 or 4 (Modern Professional)

Are you in a creative field?
→ Template 6 or 7 (Creative)

Are you applying for a senior role (Director+)?
→ Template 8 (Executive)

Are you a recent grad with limited work experience?
→ Template 9 (Entry-Level)

Are you switching careers?
→ Template 10 (Career Change)

Not sure?
→ Template 2 (Clean Minimalist — Modern)

PART 2: FILE FORMAT — WHICH TO SUBMIT WHEN

Every template comes in .docx and PDF. Here's when to use each.

Submit .docx (Word) when:

- The job posting says "submit as .doc or .docx"
- You're applying to a legacy company or ATS
- The recruiter may need to edit or annotate your resume

Submit PDF when:

- The job posting doesn't specify a format
- You're applying to modern companies (tech, startups, creative)
- You want to guarantee formatting stays exactly as designed

Important: When submitting PDF, always export as a **text-based PDF**, not a scanned PDF or image-based PDF. Text-based PDFs parse cleanly in ATS; image PDFs fail parsing.

The Safest Strategy

Have both versions ready. When a job posting is ambiguous, submit .docx. When it specifies PDF, submit PDF. Never submit both unless the posting asks for both.

How to Export From Google Docs

1. Open the .docx template in Google Drive
2. Click **File** → **Download** → **Microsoft Word (.docx)** for Word format
3. Click **File** → **Download** → **PDF Document (.pdf)** for PDF format
4. Rename the file to **Firstname_Lastname_Resume**

PART 3: HOW TO CUSTOMIZE EACH TEMPLATE

Every template is 100% editable. Here's how to make each one your own.

Colors

Each template uses a subtle accent color — usually a dark blue, teal, or slate.

To change the color:

- In Word: Format → Style → Change color scheme
- In Google Docs: Right-click on colored text → Change text color

Keep it dark and professional. Avoid bright colors unless you're in a creative field.

Fonts

Every template uses ATS-safe fonts. If you change the font, stay within the safe list:

Safe fonts:

- Arial
- Calibri
- Helvetica
- Georgia
- Times New Roman
- Garamond

Avoid:

- Comic Sans
- Papyrus
- Impact
- Anything decorative or requiring special installation

Sections

Add or remove sections to fit your experience.

Add:

- Certifications
- Languages
- Projects
- Volunteer Work
- Publications
- Awards

Remove:

- Any section without content
- Any section that isn't relevant to the job

Length

Templates are set up for one page. If your experience requires two pages:

1. Delete any sections you don't need
2. Tighten your bullet points (one line instead of two)
3. Reduce margins slightly (but not below 0.5 inch)
4. Reduce font size to 10pt for body text (but not below)

Never go to three pages unless you're a senior academic or executive with publication records or board appointments.

Filename

Always use a professional filename: **Firstname_Lastname_Resume.pdf**

Never use:

- resume_final_v3_updated.pdf
- my resume (1).pdf
- resumeFINAL.pdf

PART 4: THE RESUME WRITING FORMULA

Here's the formula Google recommends to its own employees. It works for any industry.

The XYZ Formula

Accomplished [X] as measured by [Y], by doing [Z].

Example:

"Increased organic traffic by 47% in six months by redesigning the content strategy around long-tail keywords."

Before and After Examples

❌ **Before:**

"Responsible for managing social media accounts and creating content."

✅ **After:**

"Grew Instagram following from 2,000 to 15,000 in 6 months by creating a consistent content calendar and optimizing hashtag strategy."

❌ **Before:**

"Helped with customer support and resolved issues."

✅ **After:**

"Resolved 200+ customer tickets per week with a 96% satisfaction rate by developing a knowledge base that reduced repeat inquiries by 40%."

❌ **Before:**

"Worked on the marketing team for a startup."

✅ **After:**

"Led a 4-person marketing team that generated 500 qualified leads per month, contributing to a $2M ARR milestone within 18 months of launch."

The 3 Rules of Strong Bullet Points

1. **Start with a strong action verb.** Led, Launched, Designed, Built, Increased, Reduced, Automated, Streamlined, Negotiated, Delivered.
2. **Quantify everything you can.** Numbers signal competence. Even estimates work better than nothing.
3. **Show impact, not responsibilities.** What changed because you did the work? That's what recruiters want to know.

PART 5: RESUME SECTION TEMPLATES

Professional Summary

The Formula:

"[Job title] with [X years] of experience in [industry/field]. Track record of [specific accomplishment]. Skilled in [3–5 relevant skills]. Looking to [goal] at [type of company]."

Example:

"Digital marketing manager with 6 years of experience in SaaS and B2B technology. Track record of growing organic traffic 200%+ for three companies. Skilled in content strategy, SEO, paid advertising, and marketing analytics. Looking to lead growth marketing at a fast-growing tech company."

Experience Section

The Format:

```
text
[Job Title] | [Company] | [Location]
[Month Year] – [Month Year or Present]

• Accomplished [X] as measured by [Y], by doing [Z].
• Accomplished [X] as measured by [Y], by doing [Z].
• Accomplished [X] as measured by [Y], by doing [Z].
```

Example:

```
text
Digital Marketing Manager | Acme SaaS | Austin, TX
Jan 2022 – Present

• Increased organic traffic from 45K to 132K monthly visitors by implementing an SEO-first content strategy across blog, product pages, and case studies.
• Grew email list from 8,000 to 34,000 subscribers in 18 months by launching a gated content series with 12 downloadable resources.
• Managed $15K/month paid ad budget across Google and LinkedIn, achieving a 3.2x ROAS on B2B lead generation campaigns.
```

Skills Section

The Formula:

```
text
Technical: [skill 1], [skill 2], [skill 3], [skill 4]
Tools: [tool 1], [tool 2], [tool 3]
Soft skills: [skill 1], [skill 2], [skill 3]
```

Example:

```
text
Technical: SEO, SEM, content strategy, marketing analytics, A/B testing
Tools: Google Analytics, HubSpot, Ahrefs, Salesforce, Figma
Soft skills: Team leadership, project management, cross-functional collaboration
```

Education Section

The Format:

```
text
[Degree] in [Field]
[University Name], [Location]
[Graduation Year]
```

- Optional: GPA if above 3.5
- Optional: Relevant coursework, honors, or activities

PART 6: THE KEYWORD OPTIMIZATION CHECKLIST

ATS systems rank your resume by how well your content matches the job description. Aim for **60–80% keyword coverage** without stuffing.

How to Find Keywords

1. Read the job description carefully
2. Note repeated skills, tools, and phrases
3. Work them into your bullet points naturally

Example: If the job says "experience with Salesforce CRM" and you have it, mention Salesforce specifically. Don't just say "CRM experience."

The Keyword Checklist

Before you submit, run through this list:

- □ I've identified the top 10 keywords from the job description
- □ Each of those keywords appears at least once in my resume
- □ Keywords are used naturally, not stuffed
- □ My job title matches the one in the posting (or a close equivalent)
- □ I've included specific tools and platforms named in the posting

- □

I've included industry-specific terms (not just generic skills)

Free ATS Checkers

Run your resume against the job description before submitting:

- **Jobscan** — Limited free tier, most accurate ATS parsing
- **Resume Worded** — Free keyword match score
- **SkillSyncer** — Free ATS scan

Aim for a match score of 60–80%. Above 80% can look like keyword stuffing.

PART 7: THE COVER LETTER TEMPLATE

A cover letter isn't always required, but when it is, here's the 4-paragraph structure.

Paragraph 1: Hook

Reference something specific about the company or role. Not "I'm writing to apply for..." but "When I saw [Company] is launching [specific project], I knew I had to reach out."

Paragraph 2: Proof

One specific example of a relevant accomplishment. Use the XYZ formula. Show you can do the job.

Example:

"In my current role at Acme SaaS, I increased organic traffic by 47% in six months by redesigning the content strategy around long-tail keywords. I'd bring the same approach to [Company]'s current SEO challenges."

Paragraph 3: Fit

Why this company specifically? Show you've done research. Mention their mission, product, or recent news.

Paragraph 4: Close

Confident, clear call to action.

Example:

"I'd welcome the chance to discuss how I can help [Company] achieve [specific goal]. I'm available for a call any time this week."

Cover Letter Tips

- **Keep it under 300 words.** Recruiters skim.
- **Use the same header as your resume.** Name, email, phone.
- **Address it to a specific person if possible.** Check LinkedIn for the hiring manager's name.
- **Match the tone of the company.** A formal law firm gets a formal letter.
- **Never send a generic cover letter.** If you're not going to customize it, don't send one at all.

PART 8: THE LINKEDIN PROFILE TEMPLATE

Your LinkedIn profile is your resume's wingman. Recruiters check it after they see your resume. Here's how to optimize it.

Headline Template

Formula: [Current or Target Job Title] | [Specialty] | [Key Achievement or Value Prop]

Examples:

- "Digital Marketing Manager | SEO & Content Strategy | Grew Organic Traffic 200%+ at 3 SaaS Companies"
- "Product Designer | UX Research & Design Systems | Previously at Airbnb & Stripe"

Summary Template

Formula:

[What you do] + [Who you do it for] + [Key accomplishment] + [What you're looking for]

Example:

"I help B2B SaaS companies grow organic traffic through SEO-first content strategy. In my current role at Acme, I've grown monthly visitors from 45K to 132K. Previously built content programs at [Company 1] and [Company 2]. Looking to connect with SaaS founders and marketing leaders."

Experience Section

Mirror your resume but in longer form. Use LinkedIn's media attachments to add case studies, project examples, or portfolio links.

Skills Section

List 15–20 skills. LinkedIn allows 50, but only the top 3 appear on your profile header. Choose your top 3 carefully — they should match the roles you're targeting.

Recommendation Strategy

Ask 3–5 former colleagues or clients for LinkedIn recommendations. Use this template:

"Hi [Name] — I'm updating my LinkedIn profile and was wondering if you'd be willing to write a short recommendation. Specifically, it would help if you could mention [specific project or skill]. Happy to write one for you too. Thanks so much!"

PART 9: INTERVIEW PREPARATION — THE STAR METHOD

The 30 most common interview questions can be answered using the STAR method.

The STAR Format

Situation — Set the scene. What was the context?
Task — What was your specific responsibility?
Action — What did you do?
Result — What was the outcome?

Example

Question: "Tell me about a time you solved a difficult problem."

Answer:

"**Situation:** Our content marketing was producing low-quality leads and our sales team was complaining. **Task:** I was asked to redesign the content strategy to attract higher-intent prospects. **Action:** I audited our top 20 blog posts, identified three topics our ideal customer searched for, and rewrote the content around those topics. I also introduced gated case studies. **Result:** Within six months, qualified leads increased 68% and sales cycle time dropped 22%."

The Most Common Interview Questions

1. Tell me about yourself.
2. Why do you want to work here?
3. What are your greatest strengths?
4. What's your biggest weakness?
5. Why are you leaving your current job?
6. Where do you see yourself in 5 years?
7. Tell me about a challenge you overcame.
8. Describe a time you worked on a team.
9. How do you handle conflict?
10. Tell me about a time you failed.
11. What's your greatest accomplishment?
12. Why should we hire you?
13. Tell me about a time you led a team.
14. How do you prioritize your work?
15. What motivates you?
16. Tell me about a time you had to learn something quickly.
17. What do you do outside of work?
18. What salary are you looking for?
19. Do you have any questions for us?
20. Tell me about a time you disagreed with your boss.

The remaining 10 questions follow similar patterns. For each, use the STAR method and reference specific achievements from your resume.

PART 10: THE FINAL CHECKLIST BEFORE YOU SUBMIT

Before you submit your resume for any application, run through this checklist.

Formatting

- □

- □ Single-column layout
- □ No tables, text boxes, or graphics
- □ Standard section headings
- □ Standard font (Arial, Calibri, Helvetica)
- □ Body text 10–12pt, headers 12–14pt
- □ No content in headers or footers
- □ No images or photos (for US applications)
- □ Saved as .docx or text-based PDF

Content

- □ Professional summary at the top
- □ Every bullet point starts with a strong action verb
- □ Every achievement is quantified where possible
- □ Length is 1 page (under 10 years experience) or 2 pages max
- □ No "References available upon request"
- □ No personal pronouns (I, me, my)
- □ No objective statement

- □

  No age, marital status, or nationality

Tailoring

- □

  The top 10 keywords from the job description appear in my resume
- □

  My job title matches the posting (or a close equivalent)
- □

  I've run a free ATS scan and scored 60–80% match

Final Review

- □

  Read out loud to catch awkward phrasing
- □

  Friend or family member reviewed for typos
- □

  Professional filename: Firstname_Lastname_Resume.pdf

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

What makes a resume pass ATS?

Standard single-column formatting, no graphics or tables, standard section headings, standard fonts, and keywords from the job description.

How many templates are included?

10 templates in .docx and PDF format, each designed for a different situation.

Are these templates really free?

Yes. All 10 templates, matching cover letters, the writing guide, keyword checklist, interview prep, and LinkedIn template — free.

Can I use these for any industry?

Yes. The 10 templates cover corporate, tech, creative, executive, and entry-level styles.

Do I need special software?

No. The .docx files open in Microsoft Word, Google Docs (free), or Apple Pages.

How long should my resume be?

One page for candidates with under 10 years of experience. Two pages for 10+ years. Never three unless you're a senior academic or executive.

Should I include a photo?

For US applications, no. Photos are not standard practice and can trigger bias concerns. For international applications, check local conventions.

What if I don't have quantified achievements?

Estimate. "Increased sales by ~15%" is better than "Increased sales." Numbers signal competence even when approximate.

CONCLUSION

You now have:

- 10 ATS-optimized resume templates
- A decision tree to pick the right one
- The exact customization steps
- File format guidance
- The XYZ formula for writing bullets
- Templates for every resume section

- The keyword optimization checklist
- The cover letter structure
- The LinkedIn profile template
- The STAR method for interviews
- The final submission checklist

The only thing left is to customize a template and apply. Pick the one that fits your situation, fill it in, run the ATS check, and submit.

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